The Last Storytender: art guide

How to make the game's sprites, floor tiles and item icons in one consistent, production-quality style, with Scenario, a website built for making game art. Every asset the game needs is listed with its size, its states and frames, a prompt, and the file name to save it as. When you are done, push the files and Claude puts them in the game.

1. Where the art stands now

The overworld reads well from a distance, but the art is not production quality yet. It comes from five different places, and up close they do not match:

- **Your Gemini sheets** (trees, houses, signs, chest, Storytender sheet): the best and most consistent art in the game.
- **Stable Diffusion tries** (new Storytender, villagers, Errors, bosses, objects): the line weight, colours and scale differ from the Gemini art, and many came out as sheets of tiny figures that had to be cut apart and blown up (the bosses especially).
- **The Godot game's own drawings** (memory figures, the Critic, the Spoiler, plates, gates).
- **Flat shapes I drew as stand-ins**: gaps, planks, ice, frost, ink pools, flowers, paper cuts, and the engine's plain boxes for stone blocks.
- **Animation is a puppet trick**: the Storytender's walk only moves his feet, nobody else animates, the villagers only face one way.



Close-ups from the game: notice the different outline weights and shading between the house and Garrick, the plain boxes in the forge, and the flat table and stand-in blocks in Maud's hall.

2. The website: Scenario

scenario.com is a studio made for game art (2D sprites, items, tiles and textures). What makes it right for this game: you **train it on your own art**, and after that everything it makes comes out in that style, so the whole game matches. It also removes backgrounds, works in batches, and keeps everything in a library.

- **Plan:** training your own style needs the **Pro** plan (about $45 a month at the time of writing; check the pricing page, and cancel after the month you make the art). The free tier lets you try it first.
- **Why not the others:** PixelLab is excellent but makes pixel art, which is not this game's look. Ludo.ai is a good backup for animated characters (it builds a 3D rig and renders 8 directions), but it cannot learn your style the way Scenario can.

3. Set it up (once)

Step 1. Train the style. In the repo, the folder **art/training/** holds 23 pictures I picked from your Gemini sheets (9 of the Storytender, 14 props), each a 1024 x 1024 square on parchment. In Scenario: **Train** (or Models) → new model → type **Style** → name it **Storytender Ink** → upload all 23 → Start training. It takes 20 to 60 minutes.



Step 2. Train the hero. A second model, type **Character**, named **Storytender**, with only the 9 hero_ pictures. This keeps his face, hood, backpack and lantern the same in every frame.

Step 3. Test. Generate with the Storytender Ink model: *"a wooden wheelbarrow"* with the style words below. If it looks like it belongs next to the tree and house in the training set, you are ready. If not, add 5 more of your best Gemini pieces and retrain.

4. Rules for every picture

- **One subject per picture.** Never a sheet of many. (Sprite sheets of frames are the one exception, see the Storytender.)
- **Same camera for everything:** isometric three-quarter view from above, the way your house and chest look. Light from the top left.
- **Plain parchment background**, then use Scenario's **Remove background** and download a **transparent PNG**.
- **Make it big** (1024 px). I shrink it to game size, which also hides small faults.
- **Same size inside a set:** all frames of one character, both states of one object, drawn at the same scale with the feet on the same line.
- **Keep only the best** of each, saved with the exact file name in the tables below.

Add these style words to the end of every prompt (for props, items and creatures):

```
storybook game art, hand-drawn, clean dark-brown ink outline, flat cel shading, muted warm colours,
isometric three-quarter view from above, light from the top left, single subject, centered, full
```

```
view, plain parchment background
```

5. Characters

Use the **Storytender** character model for him, the **Storytender Ink** style model for everyone else. Directions: **S** = facing you, **SE** = three-quarter front turned to the right, **E** = side view facing right, **NE** = three-quarter back turned to the right, **N** = back view. I mirror the right-facing ones for the left. For animation frames, make the standing pose first, then make each frame with that picture as the **reference image** (image-to-image, low-to-medium strength) and change only the pose words.

File name	What	Frames / states	Size in game
hero_<dir>_idle_1..2	The Storytender standing, breathing	2 frames x 5 directions	64 px tall
hero_<dir>_walk_1..4	Walking: right foot forward, passing, left foot forward, passing	4 x 5 directions	64 px
hero_<dir>_strike_1..3	Quill strike: raise overhead, swing down, follow through	3 x 5	64 px (quill may reach out)
hero_<dir>_dash	Leaning far forward mid-dash	1 x 5	64 px
hero_<dir>_lantern	Holding the lantern up, teal light	1 x 5	64 px
hero_<dir>_creep	Crouched low, tiptoeing	1 x 5	50 px
hero_crumple	Lying crumpled like a paper drawing	1	30 px
garrick_<dir>	Broad blacksmith, short dark beard, leather apron, hammer at belt, kind tired face	S, SE, NE, N	82 px
pip_<dir>	Small curious child, messy hair, striped scarf, hugging an open storybook	S, SE, NE, N	62 px
maud_<dir>	Warm older baker, grey bun, floury apron, wooden bread paddle	S, SE, NE, N	76 px
figure_memory	A person from a memory: a pale, glowing cyan silhouette (used in all three memories)	1	64 px
guest_standing / guest_seated	A pale shadowy dinner guest, standing / sitting on a chair	2	58 px

Prompt for the Storytender (character model), then the direction and pose words, then the style words:

```
the Storytender, small hooded wanderer about three heads tall, face hidden in shadow with two glowing teal eyes, tan stitched tunic, satchel strap, dark green trousers, brown boots, big brown backpack with a grey gear emblem and a wrench, small glass lantern glowing teal at the hip, [facing the viewer / three-quarter front view turned right / side view facing right / three-quarter back view turned right / back view], [standing / walking, right foot forward / ...]
```

Animation tip: Scenario can also turn a standing picture into a short video and you pick frames from it ("Convert to video", prompt e.g. *"walks in place, loop"*). Pick 4 evenly spaced frames for the walk. Make sure he stays facing the same way.

6. The Errors and the bosses

One creature per picture, facing down-right (SE). I mirror them. For each: **idle**, **move** (2 frames), **attack**, and for the three the lantern turns friendly, a **friendly** look (same creature, softer colours, gentle smile).

File name	What	Size
err_bare_*	A grumpy bear missing patches of fur as if erased; heavy, storybook monster (friendly: a cuddly bear)	56 px
err_mite_*	A tiny ink bug made of one scribble, many thin legs	26 px
err_runon_*	A long slow slug of dark ink made of tiny words, glossy trail (friendly: a soft cream slug)	30 px tall, 70 px long

File name	What	Size
err_dangler_*	A small creature hanging from a dangling thread, holding loose letters (friendly: holding a little sign)	50 px
err_censor_*	A stern hooded figure holding a thick black redaction bar across its front like a shield	60 px
err_ellipsis_*	Three floating ink dots in a row with a faint shadowy body, blinking	40 px
boss_critic_idle / _attack / _reckoning	Towering figure of layered red ink and torn review pages, mouth full of sharp words; reckoning: stripped thin and cracked	150 px
boss_spoiler_idle / _read / _attack	A floating open book with its last page torn out, glowing letters spilling out; read: pages fanned, glowing	130 px
boss_cold_idle / _slam	A hunched figure of frost and pale blue cloth turning one huge frozen shoulder toward the viewer	120 px
boss_scissor_idle / _cut / _jammed	A tall thin tailor, half coloured and half pencil sketch, enormous shears for hands	140 px

7. Objects

Style model, one object per picture. Objects with two states: make the first, then make the second **from the first as reference**, so they match exactly.

File name	What	Size
tree_1..6	Six round leafy storybook trees, slightly different shapes	90-120 px
house_1..3 (+ _ghost)	Small timber cottages; _ghost: the same as an unfinished grey pencil sketch	150 px
chest_closed / chest_open	Wooden treasure chest; open with a soft glow inside	40 px
post_unlit / post_lit	Wooden lantern post; lit with a warm teal flame	72 px
forge_frozen / forge_warm	Stone blacksmith forge; frozen blue still flame / roaring orange fire	120 px
oven_cold / oven_warm	Brick bread oven; cold and dark / glowing warm	104 px
sign_small / sign_wide / sign_tall	Wooden signposts with completely blank cream boards (the game writes on them)	50-62 px
plate_up / plate_down	Round stone pressure plate; raised / pressed flat	24 px
echo_plate_dim / echo_plate_lit	Diamond stone floor plate with a carved eye; dim / glowing teal	24 px
gate_closed / gate_open	Colourful painted fence gate with a padlock; swung open	120 px
storygate	A wall of pale paper strips with the word FORGOTTEN, 3 cells wide	70 px
redaction_bar	A thick floating black bar with ragged edges	70 px wide
block_stone / block_wood	A plain cube of slate / of wood, for walls in the memories	64 px
anvil, hammer, tongs, bellows	Blacksmith things; the last three as glowing keepsakes	30-50 px
shard	A floating glowing crystal splinter of memory	30 px
first_sword	A small crooked sword lying on its side	30 px
torn_page	A torn storybook page, floating	28 px
storybook	Pip's open storybook lying on the ground	60 px
word_bread / _salt / _dough / _serve	The word carved as a chunky wooden block (also: _underline, _bold, _italic for each)	40 px
dough_1..3	A lump of bread dough rising: small, half, full loaf	30 px
table_long / chair	A long kitchen table set for six / one wooden chair	60 / 30 px
portal	A swirling rift torn in the air, teal glow	90 px
crystal	A small Mnemosynth crystal on the ground	30 px
dummy	A straw training dummy on a post	60 px
scissors / patch	Giant scissors stuck in the floor / a paper cut-out patch	60 / 40 px

8. Floor tiles (the easy way)

Do **not** make isometric diamonds. Make each floor as a **flat square texture seen from straight above**: 1024 x 1024, **seamless** (Scenario has a tiling or seamless option; turn it on). I turn them into the game's diamonds myself, so the edges always join. Prompt: *"[floor], seamless texture, seen from directly above, flat, even lighting, no shadows, no objects"* plus the style words.

File name	Floor	Where
floor_meadow_1..3	Meadow grass (3 slightly different)	Prologue plains
floor_dirt	Packed dirt path with small pebbles	Paths
floor_cobble	Pale cobblestones with moss between	Thistledown
floor_flagstone	Large flat paving stones	Town square

File name	Floor	Where
floor_slate	Cold dark slate tiles with frost	Garrick's memory
floor_parchment	Printed book page with faint lines of text	Pip's memory
floor_planks	Warm wooden kitchen floorboards	Maud's memory
floor_moss	Dark green moss with tiny glowing specks	Cutting Room
side_earth / side_stone / side_wood	The SIDE of a raised step: earth with roots / stone / wood, 1024 x 512, seamless left-right	Cliff and step sides
decal_tuft, decal_flowers, decal_pebbles	Small transparent details to scatter on grass (optional; I drew these already)	Meadow

9. Item icons

69 items. Each a single object on parchment, 1024 x 1024, then background removed. Shown in the game at 48-64 px, so make them **bold and simple, readable at small size**. Same framing for all: the object centred, filling about 70% of the picture, slight three-quarter view. File name: **icon_<id>.png**. Prompt: *"[description], game item icon, single object"* plus the style words.

id (file: icon_id.png)	Name	id	Name
authors_pen	The Author's Pen	blank_page	Perfect Blank Page
bookworm_charm	Bookworm Charm	cartographer_compass	Cartographer's Compass
censors_monocle	Censor's Monocle	clarity_tonic	Clarity Tonic
cloth_binding	Cloth Binding	clover_press	Pressed Clover
dust_jacket	Dust Jacket	eternal_bookmark	The Eternal Bookmark
ghost_pepper_ink	Ghost Pepper Ink	ghostwriter_glove	Ghostwriter's Glove
glue_stub	Glue Stub	gold_leaf	Gold Leaf
golden_ratio	The Golden Ratio	herbal_tea	Herbal Tea
honey_biscuit	Honey Biscuit	hourglass_of_drafts	Hourglass of Drafts
illuminated_binding	Illuminated Binding	ink_blot	Ink Blot
lamplighter_match	Lamplighter's Match	library_binding	Library Binding
loose_thread	Loose Thread	lucky_clover	Lucky Clover
margin_doodle	Margin Doodle	marginalia_dust	Marginalia Dust
memory_jar	Memory Jar	midnight_inkwell	Midnight Inkwell
paper_clip	Paper Clip	paper_scrap	Paper Scrap
pencil_shaving	Pencil Shaving	phoenix_draught	Phoenix Draught
phoenix_ember	Phoenix Ember	pocket_workbench	Pocket Workbench
quill_feather	Quill Feather	reader_digest	Reader's Digest
reading_glasses	Reading Glasses	rubber_band	Rubber Band
silver_ribbon	Silver Ribbon	silver_thread	Silver Thread
time_in_a_bottle	Time in a Bottle	tin_bell	Tin Bell
unwritten_word	The Unwritten Word	vellum_binding	Vellum Binding
void_pearl	Void Pearl	wax_seal	Wax Seal
bookmark	The Bookmark	bookmark_charm	Bookmark Charm
eraser_crumbs	Eraser Crumbs	first_edition	The First Edition
footnote	The Footnote	gilded_binding	Gilded Binding
hardcover_binding	Hardcover Binding	highlighter	The Highlighter
index_tab	Index Tab	ink_flask	Ink Flask
ink_vial	Ink Vial	lantern_oil	Lantern Oil
leatherbound_binding	Leatherbound Binding	margin_note	Margin Note
oxford_comma	The Oxford Comma	paperback_binding	Paperback Binding
red_pen	The Red Pen	softcover_binding	Softcover Binding
sticky_note	Sticky Note	thimble	The Tailor's Thimble
torn_page	The Torn Page	void_ink	Void Ink
warm_loaf	Warm Loaf		

The names describe the objects (a Glue Stub is a stubby glue stick, Void Ink is a bottle of black glittering ink, a Pocket Workbench is a tiny folding toolbox...). If one is unclear, ask me and I will write its description.

10. Hand it over

- Save every file with the name from the tables, as a **transparent PNG**, into **art/incoming2/** in these folders: **characters, errors, bosses, objects, tiles, items**.
- In the game folder: **git add art/incoming2**, **git commit -m "New art"**, **git push origin main**.
- Tell me. I check each one, fit sizes and feet, build the animations, and put it all in the game. If something is off I tell you which file to redo and how.
- You do not need everything at once. Best order: **the Storytender, then floor tiles, then objects, then the Errors, then items, then bosses and villagers.**

Prices and plan names are from November 2026 and change often; check scenario.com/pricing before you pay.